

FREE GUIDE · 2026–2027

The Vancouver Wedding *Photo Planner*

Sample timelines, the best light by season, my favourite Vancouver photo locations, a family photo list and a rain plan, so your photos come together calmly on the day.

JOENELL
Photography

SAMPLE WEDDING-DAY TIMELINES

How much time do *photos really need?*

These are real-world starting points based on a 3:00 pm ceremony. Every wedding is different, and I'll build yours with you once we know your venue, your sunset time and how many family groups you'd like.

2 hours

CEREMONY + PORTRAITS

2:45	Arrival, details, guests arriving
3:00	Ceremony
3:30	Hugs, confetti, congratulations
3:45	Family photos (6–8 groups)
4:10	Wedding party
4:20	Couple portraits
4:45	Wrap-up

4 hours

MOST POPULAR

1:30	Getting ready, details, dress
2:15	First look (optional)
3:00	Ceremony
3:30	Family & wedding party
4:15	Couple portraits
4:45	Cocktail hour, guests
5:15	Entrance, room, first toasts

6 hours

THE FULL STORY

12:30	Getting ready, both sides
2:00	First look + portraits
3:00	Ceremony
3:30	Family & wedding party
4:30	Cocktail hour
5:30	Dinner, speeches
6:15	Golden-hour portraits, first dance

> **Tip:** leave 10–15 minutes of buffer after the ceremony. Hugs always take longer than anyone expects, and it's one of the best parts of the day to photograph.

Questions to answer first

- What time is sunset on your date, and where will you be?
- Do you want a first look, or to see each other at the aisle?
- How many family groups, and who are the "must haves"?
- Are both of you getting ready in the same place?
- Which moments would you be sad to miss: speeches, first dance, sparkler exit?



THE BEST LIGHT IN VANCOUVER

Plan around the light, *not just the clock.*

A simple spot in soft light beats a famous spot in harsh midday sun. The hour before sunset is warm, flattering and calm, and it's where I'll aim your portraits whenever the day allows.

Sunset changes a lot through the year

- **Late June:** sunset around 9:20 pm, so golden hour falls after dinner. Plan a short portrait break.
- **December:** sunset around 4:15 pm, so plan portraits early in the afternoon.
- **Spring and autumn:** sunset in the early evening, an easy fit for most timelines.
- I'll check the exact sunset for your date and location when we plan.

What each season brings

- **Spring (Mar–May):** cherry blossoms, then rhododendrons and tulips.
- **Summer (Jun–Sep):** long evenings, beaches and mountain views.
- **Autumn (Oct):** golden leaves in the parks.
- **Winter (Nov–Feb):** moody forests, snowy peaks and holiday lights.



Cloudy day? Good news.

Overcast skies give soft, even light that's flattering on skin. Forest trails like those in Stanley Park or Lynn Canyon are beautiful on grey days.

If it rains

- Choose a covered backup spot early: a porch, a covered walkway, a heritage building.
- Clear umbrellas photograph beautifully.
- Rain usually clears in short windows. We'll step out for 10 minutes when it does.

WHERE TO TAKE YOUR PHOTOS

Ten Vancouver favourites, *and who they suit.*

Stanley Park

Seawall sunsets, the Rose Garden, Lost Lagoon and forest trails in one park.

BEST FOR VARIETY

Queen Elizabeth Park

Formal gardens and city-and-mountain views from Vancouver's highest point.

BEST FOR ELEGANT, POLISHED

VanDusen Botanical Garden

Lush, colourful garden paths, beautiful in spring and summer.

BEST FOR GARDEN ROMANCE

Spanish Banks & Kitsilano

Wide sandy beaches, ocean, mountains and the city skyline.

BEST FOR RELAXED SUNSETS

Gastown

Cobblestones, brick and heritage street lamps right downtown.

BEST FOR URBAN, EDITORIAL

Lighthouse Park

Old-growth forest and granite rocks above the ocean in West Vancouver.

BEST FOR WILD AND NATURAL

Whytecliff Park

Rocky coves and a small island just off the shore.

BEST FOR DRAMATIC COASTLINE

Lynn Canyon

Rainforest, a suspension bridge and soft forest light.

BEST FOR CLOUDY DAYS

Bowen Lookout, Cypress

A huge view over Howe Sound after a short hike.

BEST FOR PROPOSALS & ADVENTURE

Whistler

Lakes, alpine meadows and snowy peaks, about two hours away.

BEST FOR ELOPEMENTS

> **Good to know:** some parks and gardens need a permit or a booking for professional photography, and a few charge admission. I'll check the current rules for your spots and help you plan parking and walking time.



YOUR FAMILY PHOTO LIST

Fill this in, *and family photos take minutes.*

Most couples need 6–10 groups. Start big, end small, so grandparents can sit down early. Name one confident friend or relative to help gather people.

1	Couple with both families, everyone together	
2	Couple with Partner A's extended family	
3	Couple with Partner A's immediate family	
4	Couple with Partner A's parents	
5	Couple with Partner B's extended family	
6	Couple with Partner B's immediate family	
7	Couple with Partner B's parents	
8	Couple with grandparents	
9	Couple with the wedding party	
10	Anything special to you:	

The week-before checklist

- [ ] Final timeline shared with your photographer, planner and venue
- [ ] Family photo list sent, with one helper named
- [ ] Details set aside together: rings, invitations, shoes, perfume, vows
- [ ] Rain backup spot confirmed
- [ ] Any location permits or bookings in hand
- [ ] Phone numbers for your photographer and coordinator
- [ ] Buffer time built in after the ceremony
- [ ] A few minutes alone together planned for the day

COLLECTIONS & PRICING

Calm, natural photos, *with clear prices.*

I'm Joenell, a Vancouver wedding, elopement, engagement and proposal photographer. I keep the day relaxed, give gentle direction, and photograph the moments as they really happen.

The Vow

$1,000

Up to 2 hours · at least 75 edited images · gallery within 4 weeks

The Story

$1,450

Up to 4 hours · at least 160 edited images · gallery within 6 weeks

The Complete Story

$1,950

Up to 6 hours · at least 250 edited images · gallery within 8 weeks

Elopements from $850 · Engagement sessions $225 · Surprise proposals $250 · Sneak peek within 72 hours for weddings · Metro Vancouver travel included · Prices in CAD.





Tell me about your plans.

Send your date and venue, and I'll reply with availability and a timeline idea, usually within 24 hours.

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